

Checkpoint 1 – Play Test Observation Notes

Introduction:

During playtesting, our main goal was to gather general feedback on clarity, visuals, and player engagement since project was still in the early stages. We believe that player input was successfully taken during the session, but due to an error in the code, players were unable to move around in the game environment. So, we guided them through the levels manually and focused on showing the art, layout, and overall concept. The final boss level was also not yet complete, so we explained that portion conceptually to help players understand the story and gameplay.

Observation/Comment from Player	Changes Needed
Many players said the concept seemed interesting but a bit unclear at first since they couldn't actually play through the movement portion.	Create a short introduction or tutorial screen explaining the main goal, storyline, and basic mechanics to help players understand what to do right away once the movement issue is fixed.
Players mentioned that while they understood the general theme, they were curious how each level connected to the Museum Heist storyline.	Add short narrative descriptions or dialogue boxes to link each level to the heist theme and provide context for the player's objectives.
Players were unsure what actions they would be able to take once movement was functional.	Implement clear visual and auditory feedback for actions such as collecting items or interacting with objects once the coding issue is resolved.
Some players commented that without movement, it was hard to tell what the pacing of the gameplay would feel like.	Continue developing pacing by adding small interactive moments or events between main objectives once the movement is enabled.
Players said the visuals were strong, but the layout of some levels made it hard to tell where the player would go next.	Add arrows, cues, or subtle indicators to guide players through the levels once navigation becomes interactive.

Positive comments:

- Players said the Museum Heist theme was creative and “felt like Money Heist or Red Notice”
- One mentioned, “The concept is unique. I like the different rooms representing different challenges or puzzles.”
- Overall, players agreed that once the movement and boss level are complete, the game could become very engaging and immersive.

Takeaways:

Even though the game wasn't fully functional during the playtest, we got valuable feedback and insight into both our project's strengths and pitfalls. Players responded positively to our overall theme and concept, but the implementation and technical aspects still need to be improved. We have the need for clearer objectives, stronger narrative explanations, and more defined instructions and functions. Moving forward, we will focus on improving the functionality of our mechanics, resolving coding errors, and overall completing all levels to ensure completion of checkpoint and a strong foundation for the rest of our project.